

SOURCE INTEGRITY

This deck uses the earliest recoverable Greek text, not a claim that a lost physical autograph survives unchanged.

It distinguishes:

1. Historical tradition
2. Gospel redaction
3. Scribal variant
4. Later interpretation

The four Gospels are four literary witnesses, not four fully independent votes. Matthew and Luke reuse Mark and other traditions; John reframes the baptism as witness.

Critical-text basis: SBLGNT v1.2
Full Greek, parallels and transmission notes:
bible.saga1001.com



FROM JOHN TO JESUS

THE WITNESS · THE WATER · THE LIGHT

54-CARD GOSPEL DECK INSTRUCTION & SOURCE GUIDE

John means John the Baptist.

bible.saga1001.com

HOW TO USE THE DECK

STORY ORDER

Lay each suit A through K to follow that Gospel's John-to-Jesus sequence.

FOUR-WAY READING

Compare the same event across suits and notice what each author retains, adds, relocates or reframes.

SOURCE STUDY

Use the verse and archive ID on each card to open its Greek text and version history.

PLAY

The deck keeps standard ranks and suits, so it may also be used as an ordinary 54-card deck.

FOUR GOSPELS · FOUR SUITS



♠ MARK

Earliest extant narrative spine · c. 65–75 CE



♦ MATTHEW

Explanation, fulfillment and explicit additions · c. 80–95 CE



♣ LUKE

Social ethics, prayer and returned testimony · c. 80–95 CE



♥ JOHN

Witness, light and theological reframing · c. 90–100 CE

Editorial navigation, not equal historical weight.

READING ONE CARD

8 ♦

MATTHEW

STORY IMAGE

I need to be baptized by you...

Matthew 3:14 · c. 80–95 CE

MATTHEAN REDACTION

The card shows a concise quotation. The archive holds the full Greek unit, exact speaker, parallels, source status and version-history note.

SOURCE LABELS

EARLIEST EXTANT NARRATIVE

Mark's surviving narrative spine.

MULTIPLE SYNOPTIC ATTESTATION

Shared material with literary dependence noted.

MATTHEAN / LUKAN REDACTION

A later author's documented literary framing.

JOHANNINE REFRAMING

The baptism becomes remembered witness.

TEXTUAL VARIANT

Ancient manuscripts preserve concrete alternative readings.

SOURCE CAUTION

A single-source tradition is not independently confirmed. No secret editor is invented where evidence identifies none.